

22 Talking about the past

The past simple describes events that happened at a definite time in the past, or the state of things at a particular point in time.

-  **New language** The past simple of “to be”
- Aa Vocabulary** Jobs, town, and life events
-  **New skill** Talking about past states

22.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE PAST SIMPLE OF “TO BE”

Any action that happened and was completed in the past can be described in the past simple. The past simple of “to be” is “was” or “were.”

This is the present simple.
Jill is a businesswoman now. 
She was a student in 1985. 
This is the past simple. This is a definite time in the past.



22.2 HOW TO FORM THE PAST SIMPLE OF “TO BE”

The past simple of “to be” changes with the subject.

SUBJECT	“TO BE”	REST OF SENTENCE
I	was	a student.
You	were	
He / She / It	was	
We / They / You	were	students.

22.3 FURTHER EXAMPLES THE PAST SIMPLE OF “TO BE”

He was a doctor for 40 years. 

We were at the library yesterday. 

She was a Broadway star in the 1960s. 

There were lots of people at the party. 

There was a party last night. 

They were at the movies last week. 

